

How to Use This Template

Everything you need to get from download to a finished, application-ready resume in a few minutes.

1. Opening Your Files

1. **Word files (.doc):** double-click to open in Microsoft Word. On a Mac, they open directly in Pages as well.
2. **Google Docs:** go to Google Drive → New → File upload, then right-click the file → Open with → Google Docs.
3. **PDF files:** open with any PDF reader to see exactly how the design should look — use these as your visual reference while editing the Word file.

2. Editing the Template

1. Click directly into any placeholder text (shown in *italics* or as **// PROMPTS**) and type over it with your own information.
2. To add or remove a bullet point, place your cursor at the end of a line and press Enter for a new one, or select a full line and delete it.
3. Keep formatting simple as you edit — avoid adding tables, text boxes, or columns, which can interfere with applicant tracking systems.

3. Changing Colors & Fonts

1. **Accent color:** select a section heading, go to the Home tab → Font Color, and apply your chosen color to all headings for a consistent look.
2. **Font:** select all text (Ctrl/Cmd + A) and choose a new font from the Home tab. Keep one font throughout for a clean, professional result.

4. Saving & Applying

1. When you're finished editing, go to File → Save As → and choose PDF as the file type — this is the safest format to submit to most employers.
2. Name your file clearly: *FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf*
3. Keep the original template file untouched so you always have a clean copy to start from for your next application.

Included in this bundle: matching Cover Letter & References templates, 4 bonus guides (resume writing, ATS formatting, interview prep, and job search strategy), and a Job Application Tracker spreadsheet.